Terms and Conditions: IDOL Hackathon 2026

The IDOL Hackathon (the "Program") is organized by the Manila Electric Company (the "Organizer"). The participants will be challenged to work on projects (each a "Project", and collectively the "Projects") that align with the official hackathon challenge statements. Participants are encouraged to apply their knowledge of science, technology, and design to build innovative software and/or hardware prototypes.

PLEASE READ AND UNDERSTAND THESE TERMS AND CONDITIONS (the "TERMS") CAREFULLY, AS THEY APPLY TO YOUR APPLICATION AND PARTICIPATION IN THE EVENT. BY SUBMITTING YOUR REGISTRATION AND OTHER REQUIREMENTS TO THE ORGANIZER, YOU AUTOMATICALLY ACCEPT THESE TERMS AND VOLUNTARILY AGREE TO BE BOUND BY THEM.

A. ELIGIBILITY AND REGISTRATION

1. Participant Eligibility

1.1. The Program is open to students who are currently:

i. Undergraduates (no existing bachelor's degree); and

ii. Enrolled senior high school and college students aged 18 and above (by date of application) from reputable educational institutions.

2. Team Composition

2.1. Applicants must form teams consisting of a minimum of two (2) and a maximum of five (5) members.

3. Verification and Compliance

3.1. They must submit proof of enrollment or any equivalent documentation from their school.

3.2. All applicants must comply with the Organizer's registration requirements, including the submission of signed TERMS and Privacy Notice and Consent.

3.3. Failure to comply with these requirements may result in disqualification from the Program or forfeiture of any vested recognition or awards.

4. Registration

The applicants from each team should select their authorized representative (the "Representative") who shall send an email to hackathon@meralcopoweracademy.org with the subject "IDOL HACKATHON 2026 APPLICATION - (GROUPNAME)".

4.1. The following documents should be attached:

i. Team Application Form;

ii. Verification documents of all members (refer to 3.1 or 3.2); and,

iii. Signed TERMS and Privacy Notice and Consent of all members.

4.2. The email address and mobile number of the Representative will be used for all communications released by the Organizer. It is the Participant's responsibility to ensure that the contact information provided is accurate and up to date.

4.3. Deadline of submission is on **October 23, 2026, 11:59PM** unless otherwise advised by the Organizers.

4.4. All registrations will be subject for validation.

4.4.1. For all valid registrations, the Representatives will receive an invite to participate in the Hackathon Qualifying Phase.

4.4.2. For invalid registrations, the Representatives will receive a notice from the Organizer detailing the lack of, or invalid documents, submitted by them.

4.5. Representatives who did not receive any communications from the Organizer by the time that the Program starts shall already be considered as ineligible to participate in the Program, unless the Organizer, in its sole discretion, decides otherwise.

B. SUBMISSION AND EVALUATION OF PROPOSALS

1. In the Hackathon Qualifying Phase, all successful registrants, hereinafter referred to as the "Participants", must submit their proposal to participate in the Hackathon proper to hackathon@meralcopoweracademy.org with the subject "IDOL HACKATHON 2026 PROPOSAL - (GROUPNAME)".

2. The proposal must be a 1-page PDF document that includes problem statement and a proposed solution that demonstrates your ability to identify challenges, think critically, and develop innovative approaches. The document should be in a readable format with a minimum font size of 10.

2.1. **IMPORTANT:** The proposal submitted during registration is for evaluation purposes only. Selected participants will receive the official hackathon challenge statements and choose one challenge to address during the hackathon.

3. Last day for submission of proposals will be on October 23, 2026 until 11:59 PM only, unless otherwise advised by the Organizers.

4. Proposals will be reviewed and evaluated by the Organizer. The top 10 teams will advance to the Hackathon Proper.

5. Results of the proposal screening will be released on November 4, 2026 via email.

6. Qualified teams are expected to attend the orientation on the morning of November 11, 2026 and be ready for the 2-day Hackathon from November 12, 2026 to November 13, 2026.

C. PROGRAM DURATION AND REQUIREMENTS

1. The Program shall run for the duration specified in the event schedule, commencing on October 23, 2026, with the qualifying phase and continuing through the Hackathon Proper, Judging and Announcement of Winners on November 12-13, 2026.

2. All Participants understand and agree to the conditions set forth in the Participation Waiver and Release of Liability as specified in Annex "A".

3. Participants are expected to work on their Projects using their own resources unless otherwise specified by the Organizer.

4. Participants may leave the venue, but at least one representative must remain present at the venue throughout the hacking period.

5. All devices, equipment, and materials related to the Hackathon Project must remain at the venue if the Participants leave during the event.

D. SUBMISSION REQUIREMENTS AND JUDGING CRITERIA

1. Projects must be developed in line with the official hackathon challenge statements and must adhere to the guidelines set forth by the Organizer.

2. All source code, design, and assembly work on the Projects must be done from November 12, 2026 9:00 AM until November 13, 2026 9:00 AM.

3. Submission must include all relevant files (e.g., GitHub repository link) and be completed before November 13, 9:30 AM. Late submissions will not be accepted.

4. Any form of plagiarism, cheating, intellectual property infringement, or unethical behavior will result in immediate disqualification.

5. Submission must not contain any libelous, defamatory, unlawful, or otherwise inappropriate content.

6. Projects will be judged based on the following criteria:

Criteria	Short Description
Innovation 30%	Refers to the Project's degree of innovation reflecting novelty, originality, and inventive thinking.
Functionality 25%	Project shall be evaluated based on its reliability, stability, and overall user experience.
Impact 20%	Solution should have practical value and wide potential reach.
Technical Challenge 15%	The implementation demonstrates advanced technical skills, creativity in applying technology, or problem-solving.
Presentation 10%	Project Presentation shall be assessed based on the clarity of delivery, visual aids, storytelling, and ability to answer questions convincingly.

E. OVERNIGHT STAY

1. Supervision and Safety

1.1. Participants are responsible for their own safety and conduct during the overnight stay. The Organizer will provide basic security and supervision but will not be held liable for any injuries, damages, losses or incidents that occur due to or as a result of the Participants' actions, accidents or untoward events.

1.2. Participants are required to follow all safety, security and health protocols and instructions given by the Organizer.

2. Designated Resting Areas

2.1. Participants are expected to sleep only in designated areas assigned by the Organizer.

2.2. Participants must maintain cleanliness and orderliness within the designated sleeping areas and adhere to any guidelines set for their use.

3. Behavioral Expectations

3.1. Quiet hours will be observed between 12:00 AM and 6:00 AM. Participants must keep noise to a minimum during these hours to ensure proper rest for all.

3.2. Consumption of alcohol, smoking, and use of illegal substances are strictly prohibited during the event, including overnight hours. Violation of this rule will lead to disqualification and removal from the premises.

4. Medical Assistance and Emergencies

4.1. A designated first aid station and medical staff will be available on-site throughout the event. Participants should inform the event staff of any medical conditions or special needs that may require attention during the overnight stay.

5. Personal Belongings

5.1. Participants may bring their own tumbler, medicine/supplements and extra clothes.

5.2. Single-Use Plastics (SUPs) are strictly prohibited. This sustainability guideline covers all offices and facilities of Meralco.

F. PRIZES, DECLARATION OF WINNERS, AND FINALITY OF DECISIONS

1. Winning teams shall be entitled to prizes as determined by the Organizer, which will be announced prior to the start of the Program.

2. Winners will be declared immediately following the judging phase on November 13, 2026.

3. The Organizer's decision on all matters related to the Program, including the declaration of winners, is final, executory, and non-appealable.

G. INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY

1. Projects should be original and not infringe on any third-party intellectual property rights, including copyright, patent, trademark, and trade secret.

2. Under no circumstance shall the Organizer be held liable for any infringement of any intellectual property right relating to a Project. Each Participant shall defend, protect, indemnify, and hold the Organizer, its directors, officers, employees and agents, free and harmless from, and against any loss, damages, action, claim, opposition and demand from any third party in connection with any intellectual property claim relating to a Project. This provision shall survive the completion of the Program.

3. The Participants shall retain ownership of their Project's intellectual property (IP). However, the Participants fully agree that the Organizer shall have the right of first refusal to exclusively use, manufacture, develop, sell, market, acquire or distribute the Project in the event that they decide to sell, transfer, or dispose of the same to a third party. Prior to selling, transferring or disposing of the Project to a third party, the Participants must first offer the Project to the Organizer in writing under the same price, terms and conditions with which they intend to sell, transfer, or dispose of the Project to a third party. The Organizer shall have thirty (30) days from its receipt of the offer to accept or reject the same in writing. Failure of the Organizer to act on the offer within the period provided herein shall mean a waiver of its right of first refusal.

   The Organizer shall also have the option to make offer to the Participants by furnishing the Participants a written notice of its intention to buy the Project containing the terms and conditions of the same. In such case, the Participants shall have thirty (30) days from the date of receipt of the offer to provide the Organizer with a written acceptance or rejection of the offer. Failure of the Participants to act on the offer within period provided herein shall be deemed as an acceptance of the offer.

4. Participants grant the Organizer a non-exclusive, royalty-free, and irrevocable license to use, display, and promote the Projects for marketing and promotional purposes.

H. OTHER TERMS AND CONDITIONS

1. The Organizer reserves the right to refuse anyone's participation to the Program, and to request any person to cease participating in the Program if, in the sole discretion of the Organizer, such person (i) fails to comply with any of the Terms; or (ii) is found to have behaved in an illegal or anti-social manner; or (iii) is found to have violated any of these Terms. The decision of the Organizer in this regard shall be final, binding and conclusive.

2. By participating in the Program, the Participants consent to the use of their names, photo/images, videos with audio, likeness, and project details in promotional, media materials and other avenues needed by the Organizer.

3. Participants fully agree and understand that the Organizer shall not be liable for any injuries, damages, or losses incurred to or by Participants during the Program related activities/events.

4. The Participants are responsible for their own safety and well-being throughout the duration of the program-competition.

5. The Organizer reserves the right to modify, suspend, or terminate the Program at any time,

for any reason, without prior notice.

6. Personal information collected will be used solely for the purpose of organizing and administering the Program in compliance with the Data Privacy Act of 2012 and other applicable laws, rules, and regulations.

7. By participating in the Program, all Participants and their respective team members agree to abide by the terms hereof. Failure to comply may result in disqualification.

SIGNATURE PAGE:

I have carefully read the TERMS and fully understand its contents. I am signing this document voluntarily and of my own free will.

Signature: _____

Full Name: _____

Date signed: _____

ANNEX A: HACKATHON PARTICIPATION WAIVER AND RELEASE OF LIABILITY

Event: IDOL Hackathon 2026

Dates: November 12, 2026 – November 13, 2026

Location: Meralco Multi-Purpose Hall

I hereby acknowledge and agree to the following:

1. **Assumption of Risk:** I understand that participation in this Hackathon involves certain risks, including but not limited to:
    - Physical risks associated among others with prolonged sitting, lack of sleep, and potential stress.
    - Mental and emotional risks associated among others with the competitive nature of the event and potential frustration with technical challenges.
    - Health risks associated among others with exposure to other participants, potential food-borne illnesses, and general health concerns.
    - Overnight risks, including fatigue, reduced alertness, and personal safety during overnight activities.
    - Safety and security risks

2. **Release of Liability:** I hereby release and forever discharge **Meralco**, its officers, directors, employees, volunteers, and agents from any and all liability, claims, demands, actions, or causes of action arising out of or in any way connected with my participation in this Hackathon, including any injury, death, illness, damage, loss, or expense that I may suffer, especially those related to overnight stay.

3. **Medical Responsibility:** I am solely responsible for my own health, security, safety and well-being during the Hackathon. I understand that the Hackathon includes an overnight stay, and I will take all necessary precautions to ensure my personal health, security and safety. I will not hold **Meralco** liable for any medical expenses or treatment that I may require.

4. **Personal Property:** I am solely responsible for my own personal belongings and equipment during the hackathon stay. I will not hold **Meralco** liable for any loss, theft, or damage to my personal property.

5. **Overnight Stay**: I understand that the Hackathon includes an overnight component, and I agree to act responsibly during the overnight stay. I acknowledge that **Meralco** will provide reasonable safety and security measures during the event, but I am ultimately responsible for my own safety.

6. **Code of Conduct:** I agree to abide by the Hackathon's code of conduct and any other rules or regulations set forth by **Meralco**.

7. **Promotional Materials.** I grant **Meralco** the right to use my name, photo/image, videos with audio, likeness, and project details taken during the Program for promotional purposes over Meralco's website and other social media pages.

I have carefully read the above terms and fully understand the contents. I am signing this document voluntarily and of my own free will.

Signature: _____

Full Name: _____

Date signed: _____